

Toronto Green Standard (TGS) — Sustainable Building Reference Note

Source: City of Toronto (toronto.ca), current for 2026. The Toronto Green Standard is the City's set of sustainable design and performance requirements for new private and city-owned developments, in place since 2010. Version 4 took effect on May 1, 2022 for new planning applications.

The Standard is tiered: Tier 1 is mandatory and applied through the planning-approval process, while higher tiers are voluntary and can be encouraged through incentives. The tiers cover energy and greenhouse-gas performance, climate resilience, water, air quality, and ecology.

For low-rise residential buildings, TGS requires design and construction to meet ENERGY STAR for New Homes version 17.1 or R-2000, or the CHBA Net Zero Home labelling program, or the Passive House standard.

Cost-of-ownership angle: homes built to the Toronto Green Standard are more energy efficient and lower-emitting, which reduces operating costs over the ownership period and strengthens a buyer's sustainability story for a newer or new-build property.